Melbourne E-Bike Usage & Demand Analysis

Business Report

By: Diogo Silva

Executive Summary

This analysis examined ridership patterns, user behavior, seasonality, and weather impacts within the urban bike rental network. The findings reveal that demand is influenced by time of day, day of week, temperature, and weather conditions. While subscribers drive the majority of usage, both casual and recurring riders demonstrate similar trip characteristics. Overall, the system supports a mix of commuter and leisure travel and operates as a distributed network rather than being centered around a single dominant hub.

Key Findings

- Ridership peaks during late night (1 -> 3 AM), lunch hours (11 AM -> 1 PM), and evening (5-> 8 PM), indicating both commuter and leisure demand.
- Weekdays generate most overall rides; however, late-night demand is concentrated on weekends, suggesting nightlife-driven usage.
- Seasonal patterns show higher demand in February -> March and August -> October, with lower ridership in January and late year months.
- Subscribers account for the majority of trips, though trip duration and distance remain consistent across user types.
- Demand is highest in moderate temperatures (15 - 25°C) and declines sharply in extreme cold or heat.
- Heavy rain significantly reduces ridership, while mild weather drives overall usage more strongly than rainfall absence.
- Top stations (Southbank, Fitzroy, CBD Central) show similar usage levels, indicating a balanced, multi-node network.

Recommendations

- Adjust operational capacity during peak hours (1 -> 3 AM, 11 AM -> 1 PM, 5 -> 8 PM) to meet high demand periods.
- Increase bike availability and safety presence on weekends during late-night hours.
- Plan seasonal resource allocation to match demand surges in peak months.

- Focus marketing efforts on converting casual riders into subscribers to increase recurring usage.
- Consider weather-responsive operational strategies, such as promotions during mild conditions or infrastructure to mitigate rain impact.
- Maintain balanced distribution across major stations to preserve network efficiency.

Conclusion

The bike sharing system demonstrates diversified usage patterns driven by time, seasonality, and weather conditions. Demand is not solely commuter based but strongly influenced by lifestyle and leisure behavior. Strategic operational planning aligned with peak hours, seasonal trends, and weather sensitivity can enhance efficiency, rider satisfaction, and overall system performance.